

STARTER

Common Refusal Reasons & How to Avoid Them

Australia - Visitor Visa (Subclass 600, Tourist stream)

Visitor visa refusals are decided by a Department of Home Affairs case officer against the Migration Regulations. Most Tourist stream applications are decided on the written file without an interview, which makes a complete, well-organised document set especially important.

The most common specific reasons

1. Not satisfied you're a Genuine Temporary Entrant (GTE)

The case officer isn't convinced your circumstances support a genuine, temporary visit - this is the formal, named test applied to your application.

- Evidence stable ties at home: employment, family, property, or ongoing study
- Be specific and consistent about your itinerary and purpose throughout the application
- If you have Australian family or connections, that's not a problem on its own - the assessment looks at the whole picture, including your circumstances back home

2. Insufficient or unclear financial evidence

- Show funds proportionate to your stated trip length and plans, not just a single snapshot balance
- If someone else is funding your trip, include their evidence and a letter explaining the relationship and their commitment - see the Cover Letter and Sponsor Letter templates

3. Incomplete or inconsistent travel/immigration history

- Disclose all previous visas, visits, and refusals - from Australia and any other country - honestly
- An undisclosed prior refusal or visa cancellation is treated far more seriously than the underlying history itself would usually be

4. Health or character concerns not properly addressed

If you're directed to a health examination or asked for a police certificate and don't complete it, or if it raises unresolved concerns, this can affect your application independently of everything else.

5. Missing or poorly organised supporting documents

Since most decisions are made on paper, a complete, clearly labelled document set matters more here than in visa categories with an interview. See the Document Checklist (Essential tier).

REVIEW RIGHTS ARE LIMITED FOR THIS VISA

Independent merits review is generally not available for a refused Tourist stream Visitor visa application, unlike some other Australian visa categories. Check your refusal letter carefully for whether any review right applies to your specific case - your realistic path is usually a fresh, stronger application. See the Refusal Decision Guide (Premium tier).